CASE STUDY

The affair involving the Liberal Democrat David Ward, MP for Bradford East, offers a classic case study. After signing the Book of Remembrance in the Houses of Parliament on Holocaust Memorial Day in 2013 he deployed Holocaust inversion in both its inversion of reality and of morality when he said:

> Having visited Auschwitz twice, once with my family and once with local schools—I am saddened that the Jews, who suffered unbelievable levels of persecution during the Holocaust, could within a few years of liberation from the death camps, be inflicting atrocities on the Palestinians in the new state of Israel and continue to do so on a daily basis in the West Bank and Gaza.[17]

The offense to the Jewish community that Ward's Holocaust inversion caused was made worse by the fact that he made no distinction between Israel and "the Jews" and by the fact that he chose Holocaust Memorial Day—a day of national morning for victims of the Shoah—to make his statement. Letters of complaint from the Jewish community poured in to Nick Clegg, Liberal Democrat Leader and Deputy Prime Minister in the Coalition Government. These letters pointed out that Ward's Israel—Jews—Nazi comparison was antisemitic and deeply offensive. They urged the Liberal Democrat Party to remove the party whip from Ward, which would have had the effect of either expelling him permanently or suspending him temporarily from the Party. Despite this, the Party Leadership took no action against him.

Then, amid the continuing furore, Ward caused further offense to the Jewish community when he insisted on the validity of his comparison. He said:

> Because, don't forget, long before the death camps were set up, the treatment of the Jews in many of these European countries and of course following 1933, in particular in Nazi Germany, was racist, and directed at the Jewish people. It was very low level or what is regarded as low level cases and [*sic*] nastiness and harassment to begin with, and then escalated. And when you look at it—wherever it may be—the West Bank, and a declared intent by the Israeli forces to harass, often just annoy Palestinians—in terms of a check-point that will be open on certain days, and then it will be open but at a later time, and the next day, it will be open slightly earlier, so you get there and it's been shut again. . .really just to harass, in many cases to move the Palestinians from land, to just give up and move on. . . .[18]

Copyright © 2016. Nebraska. All rights reserved.

Anti-Judaism, Antisemitism, and Delegitimizing Israel, Nebraska, 2016. ProQuest Ebook Central,